

POLAND

Key Country Details Table

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of Poland
Short Form	Poland
Capital	Warsaw
Region (UN)	Eastern Europe
Government Type	Parliamentary Republic
Head of State	President Andrzej Duda
Head of Government	Prime Minister Donald Tusk
Currency	Polish Zloty (PLN)
UN Member Since	1945
MUN Standing	Active participant in peacekeeping, security, human rights, and climate talks; serves as an assertive EU voice in global forums; recent non-permanent UNSC member (2018–2019).

Recommended Books on Poland's Foreign Policy & UN Engagement

1. **"Poland's Foreign and Security Policy: Problems of Compatibility with the EU"** – Ryszard Zięba
2. **"Poland in International Relations: Continuity and Change"** – Artur Gruszczak
3. **"The Foreign Policy of Modern Poland: From Independence to the European Union"** – Piotr Wróbel
4. **"Poland and the United Nations: A Historical Perspective"** – Polish MFA Publication
5. **"The Polish Way of Peacebuilding"** – Edited by T. Kuźniar

Poland: UNHRC & Human Rights Resources

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Poland Country Page	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/poland	UN monitoring of human rights commitments
Polish Ombudsman (Rzecznik Praw Obywatelskich)	https://bip.brpo.gov.pl/en	Independent watchdog on civil and human rights

UPR Info – Poland	https://www.upr-info.org/en/review/Poland	Universal Periodic Review results and recommendations
UN Treaty Body Reports – Poland	https://tbinternet.ohchr.org/_layouts/15/TreatyBodyExternal/TBSearch.aspx	ICCPR, CAT, CRC, CEDAW compliance
Amnesty International – Human Rights Report on Poland	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/europe-and-central-asia/poland/	Focus on rule of law, refugees, and civil society
Human Rights Watch – Poland	https://www.hrw.org/europe/central-asia/poland	Independent reports on freedoms, LGBTQ+ issues
Helsinki Foundation for Human Rights	https://www.hfhr.pl/en/	National NGO reporting to UN mechanisms
Council of Europe – Poland Judgments	https://hudoc.echr.coe.int/	ECtHR cases against Poland
Poland's Ministry of Justice – Human Rights	https://www.gov.pl/web/justice	Government perspective
UN Web TV – Poland at HRC	https://webtv.un.org	Video record of participation
Open Society Foundations – Poland Rights Tracker	https://www.opensocietyfoundations.org	Critical evaluation of legal reforms

Title	Link	Relevance
Universal Periodic Review – Poland	OHCHR UPR Central Page	Official UPR reports, recommendations, and state responses (cbd.int , ohchr.org)
UPR Info – Poland Review	UPR Info Poland	NGO/UN stakeholder submissions, dialogue record
UPR Adoption Video	UN Web TV – 41st Session	Broadcast of UPR adoption session
OHCHR Poland Country Page	OHCHR Poland	Access to treaty bodies and special procedures
UNHCR Fact Sheet September 2024	ReliefWeb Fact Sheet	Data on Ukrainian refugees and protection
UNHCR Operational Update	UNHCR Global Focus	Planning interagency refugee response

Human Rights Watch 2024 Report	HRW World Report 2024	Issues: pushbacks, border violence, NGO harassment
Amnesty Report 2024	Amnesty International PDF	Covers migrant/refugee abuses, LGBTIQ discrimination
Digital Rights Violation Case	Amnesty 2021 Investigation	Metadata misuse against Afghan asylum seekers
UPR 2008 Reference Doc	UPR Polish 2008 Report (Refworld)	Historical context
Refugee Brochure 2025	UNHCR Brochure (June 2025)	Latest refugee and asylum procedural guide

Unique Aspects of Poland's UNHRC Engagement

1. **Mass Ukrainian refugee intake**—1.5 million arrivals since 2022 mark one of Europe's largest mass-receptions.
 - a. **Border pushback criticisms**—HRW flagged unlawful returns and harassment of non-Ukrainian migrants at Belarus border.
2. **Meta-data misuse against asylum seekers**—Amnesty revealed targeted processing of Afghan refugees' phone data.
3. **Reversal of "LGBT-free" zones**—Polish courts annulled discriminatory local resolutions, a significant civil rights victory.
4. **ECHR breakthrough on partnership rights**—Judgment compels legal recognition of same-sex unions.
5. **A-status ombudsman**—Poland's NHRI, the RPO, holds A-status and contributes to UNHRC processes.
6. **Anti-trafficking reforms amid refugee crisis**—new SOPs and inter-ministerial coordination address trafficking risks.
7. **Comprehensive civil society involvement**—wide-ranging NGO stakeholder submissions (e.g., Amnesty, Helsinki Foundation) in UPR engagements.